EXHIBITION

ONCE UPON A STUPA

The Light and the Lotus **exhibition in Delhi showcases the relics of the Buddha from UP's Piprahwa Stupa**



RECLAIMED PAST A view of the Delhi exhibition showcasing the Piprahwa Buddha relics recently repatriated to India

Close to the Buddha's birthplace, Lumbini, and his childhood home, Kapilvastu, lies Piprahwa village in Uttar Pradesh. After the Sakyamuni's cremation, fights broke out among several kingdoms over his remains until a Brahmin disciple, Drona, divided them fairly. The Sakyas buried their share of the relics in a stupa built in Piprahwa, around 480 BCE.

In 1897, a British estate manager, William Claxton Peppé, had the stupa excavated and found a stone coffer in which five urns had been placed. These contained fragments of the Buddha's bones—a sensational discovery—with precious offerings made

LARGE AUDIO-VISUAL PRESENTATIONS EXPLAIN THE **STUPA'S DEVELOPMENT OVER THREE STAGES** (SAKYA, ASHOKAN, KUSHANA), ITS EXCAVATION AND AFTER

THE LISTICLE

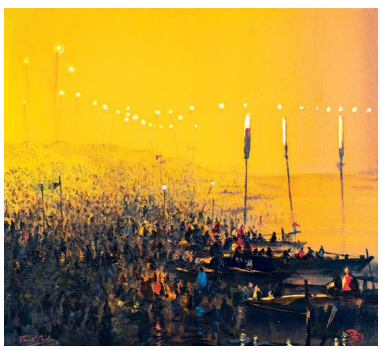
WHAT'S HOT AND HAPPENING IN THE WORLD OF ART



◀ APR. 1 (LIVE) AND APR. 1-2 (ONLINE) | ***Saffronart****, Mumbai*

Spring Auctions 2026

While Christie's gears up to auction works from the Mary and Cheney Cowles Collection of Indian Paintings and Calligraphy in London on April 28, closer home, Saffronart is all set for its Spring Auctions 2026. On offer are 140 lots of pre-modern and modern Indian art, led by a rare **Raja Ravi Varma**—'Yashoda and Krishna'—which is estimated to fetch Rs 80–120 crore.



▲ TILL APR. 20 | ***Art Alive Gallery****, Delhi*

LUMINOUS TERRAINS

No one quite embraces colour like **Paresh Maity**. His new solo exhibition, which was unveiled at Bikaner House and which now continues at Art Alive Gallery, corrals a number of eclectic landscape works, depicting everything from Srinagar's Dal Lake to the ghats of Varanasi and Rajasthan's stark desert vista to the lagoons of Venice and the French Riviera.